

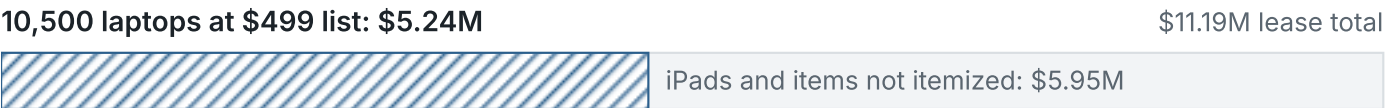
Four-year Apple lease replaces school Chromebooks

Signal	Reported by AppleInsider on Oct 1, citing the Beaumont Enterprise, and by 9to5Mac on Oct 2: Beaumont Independent School District (ISD) in Texas approved, per those reports, a four-year, \$11.19 million lease of 14,585 Apple laptops and iPads to replace its Chromebooks.
Read	The district gets 14,585 new Apple devices now and pays about \$2.8 million a year for four years (Est, our estimate: the total split in four), at 0% interest on laptops and 0.99% on iPads, per the Beaumont Enterprise via AppleInsider. Apple supplies all 14,585 on those terms. The district's stated reason, given by its deputy superintendent: a failing Chromebook fleet.
Cost	The district pays Apple \$11.19 million in all. Lenovo's competing bid had a higher four-year cost, per 9to5Mac; by how much is not disclosed.

The simple version

It works like a phone on a carrier's installment plan: the devices arrive now and the price is paid over the term. The devices are MacBook Neo laptops (Apple's lowest-priced Mac) and iPads; an even split is a quarter of the total each year (Est). Whether the \$11.19M covers repairs or support is not disclosed.

Laptops at list price: under half the bill



The money walk

1. Approval \$11.19M Four-year Apple lease approved, per AppleInsider (Oct 1) and 9to5Mac (Oct 2).	2. Devices 14,585 MacBook Neos for grade 3 up and teachers; iPads for pre-K (pre-kindergarten) to grade 2.	3. Each year \$2.8M Est Est means our estimate: a quarter of the total, paid each year.	4. Year four Not disclosed Who owns the devices when the lease ends.
---	---	--	---

The alternative: the bid the district turned down

Apple lease (chosen)		Lenovo's competing bid	
Four-year cost	\$11.19M	Four-year cost	Higher, per 9to5Mac
Devices	14,585 MacBook Neos and iPads	Devices	New Lenovo devices

Est 14,585 devices – **4,085** iPads, per the Beaumont Enterprise via AppleInsider = **10,500** laptops. 10,500 laptops × \$499 Apple education price = **\$5.24M**; \$11.19M – \$5.24M = **\$5.95M** for iPads and items not itemized.

Who else

Who	Counterparty	Size	Term	New or existing	The read
Kansas City Public Schools, Missouri (May 2026)	Apple	More than 30,000 old devices to be replaced; more than 4,500 MacBook Neos	Not public	New platform	A bigger exit from Windows and Chromebooks; ask the district its terms before benchmarking.
Peninsula School District, Washington (Aug 2026)	Apple	8,000 students	Not public	New platform	A straight Chromebook to MacBook Neo swap, the closest match to Beaumont.
St. Vrain Valley, Colorado (Feb 2018)	Apple	\$9.9M; 22,500 iPads	3-year lease	New iPads replacing iPad minis	The payment bundled repair cover, support and teacher training.
Liberty Hill ISD, Texas (Mar 2024)	Vendor not named	\$3.4M, of which \$2.76M from 2021 bonds	Purchase	New devices	Buying outright with bond money (borrowed by selling bonds) instead of leasing.

What the rules and the bids look like

Bidding rule (Texas)	Any purchase of \$50,000 or more in any twelve-month period needs a competitive method: bids, proposals, or a shared contract with other public bodies.
Interest rate	Apple: 0% on laptops, 0.99% on iPads, per AppleInsider. Lenovo's competing bid: 4% at minimum, per 9to5Mac.
Value at the end	The district projected a MacBook Neo resale value of \$180 to \$250 each, per iDrop News. Lenovo's bid guaranteed a \$10 buyback per device.
Term	Four years in Beaumont; three years at St. Vrain Valley and at Rowan-Salisbury, North Carolina.
Owned at the end	Rowan-Salisbury owns its Apple devices after its last payment on March 1, 2027.

What is not being said

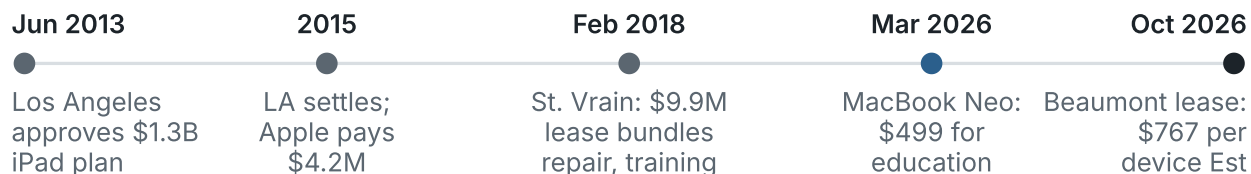
Repair savings cover a small slice of the payments.

The district spent \$469,576 on Chromebook support last school year (reported Oct 1, 2026), about 17% of one year's lease payment of about \$2.8 million (Est: the total split in four). Savings from retiring the old fleet do not pay for the lease; the district's stated case is devices that work.

The deal has two headline prices; this brief uses \$11.19 million.

On Oct 1, 2026 AppleInsider's headline said \$12.9 million; its own text, 9to5Mac and other outlets say \$11.19 million, which matches four payments of about \$2.8 million. No source reconciles them; only the signed schedule settles it.

The twist: the lease averages \$767 a device, the laptop lists at \$499



Fact Apple sells the MacBook Neo as its most affordable laptop ever, yet the lease averages \$767 per device (Est: \$11.19M over 14,585 devices). That average mixes laptops and iPads, and iPad prices were not verified. What fills the gap is not disclosed.

The everyday version

Apple leases are routine in schools. In December 2022 Rowan-Salisbury Schools in North Carolina leased 20,060 iPads, 1,900 MacBook Airs and 500 Apple TVs from Apple for \$11.5 million over three years at no interest. St. Vrain Valley's 2018 lease replaced iPad minis with iPads.

Where it breaks: "routine" covers the lease, not the switch. St. Vrain stayed on Apple; Beaumont is leaving Chromebooks, and the cost of its next refresh is not disclosed.

Three questions for an executive

What share of our devices is out of service today, and what does each one cost us in support a year?

Then: if the broken share is large, price the refresh against lost use, not against the repair bill.

How much of our vendor's per-device price sits above list, and which services does that pay for?

Then: bid those services separately, and cut the ones nobody will use.

For each bid, what is the four-year cost per device after subtracting its resale or buyback value?

Then: choose on that net cost, not the yearly payment, and get end-of-term terms in writing.

What to watch

Late Oct 2026 Apple's fiscal fourth-quarter results (date not yet set). Shows whether Beaumont is part of a pattern: yes if Apple again cites education MacBook Neo purchases displacing Chromebooks; no if it does not mention them.

Mar 1, 2027 Rowan-Salisbury's last Apple payment. Whether it then keeps, sells or re-leases shows what a district does when an Apple school lease ends.

Researched by NodeJ Deep Research. For the full research report, write to julian@nodej.ai.